

Curriculum Vitae

Personal Details:

Name: Nguyen Dang

Researcher unique identifier(s): <https://orcid.org/0000-0002-2693-6953>

Homepage: <https://ndangtt.github.io/>

Publications: [\[Official list\]](#) [\[Google Scholar\]](#)

Education and key qualifications:

16/05/2018	PhD in Computer Science KU Leuven, Belgium Supervisors: Prof. Patrick De Causmaecker and Dr Thomas Stützle Thesis title: <i>Data Analytics for Algorithm Design</i>
11/2011	MSc in Computer Science University of Science, Vietnam National University

Current and previous positions:

since 2023	Lecturer (Assistant Professor) School of Computer Science, University of St Andrews, UK
2020 – 2023	Senior Research Fellow School of Computer Science, University of St Andrews, UK
2018 – 2020	Research Fellow School of Computer Science, University of St Andrews, UK

Awards:

2025	Best paper award, GECCO 2025 (L4EC track) <i>On the importance of reward design in reinforcement learning-based dynamic algorithm configuration: a case study on OneMax with $(1+(\lambda,\lambda))$-GA</i>
2023	Nomination for best paper award, FOGA XVII <i>Using Automated Algorithm Configuration for Parameter Control.</i>
2022	Best paper award, GECCO 2023 (GECH track) <i>Theory-inspired Parameter Control Benchmarks for Dynamic Algorithm Configuration.</i>
2017	Best paper award, GECCO 2017 (ECOM track) <i>Configuring irace using surrogate configuration benchmarks.</i>

Grants:

07/2025	Young Researcher and Innovator Conference grant , funded by COST Action CA22137 - ROAR-NET (€2,385)
2023-2024	EPSRC access to High Performance Computing (£21,030)
2020-2023	Leverhulme Early Career Fellowship (£108,000)

Research Interests:

My research interest is automated algorithm design for combinatorial optimisation. I am particularly interested in automated algorithm configuration and automated algorithm selection, where the aim is to leverage both machine learning and optimisation techniques to automate the development and selection of solvers.

Academic Services:

- Organiser of Dagstuhl Seminar 27231 (Reinforcement Learning for Optimization).
- Area Chair: AutoML 2025, AutoML 2026.

- Workshop chair: GECCO 2023 and GECCO 2024.
- Workshop organiser: the second Workshop on Machine Learning for Solvers and Provers (ML4SP 2026), the 19th workshop on Constraint Modelling and Reformulation (ModRef 2020).
- Competition organiser: the 2nd International Nurse Rostering Competition (INRC-II).
- PC member: CP and ModRef (constraint programming), GECCO, EvoStar, PPSN, EvoCOP and CEC (evolutionary computation and optimisation), AAAI, IJCAI and ECAI (general AI).
- Journal reviewer: IEEE Transactions on Evolutionary Computation (TEVC), Computers & Operations Research Journal, Journal of Scheduling, Machine Learning Journal, Annals of Mathematics and Artificial Intelligence, and Journal of Artificial Intelligence Research (JAIR), Applied Soft Computing Journal (ASOC), International Transactions in Operational Research (ITOR)

Invited Talks:

- “Automated Streamliner Selection via Algorithm Configuration and Selection”, presented at the 1st Workshop on Machine Learning for Solvers and Provers (ML4SP), CP/SAT/SoSC 2025, Glasgow.
- “Dynamic Algorithm Configuration”, presented at the School of Computing Science and Mathematics at University of Stirling (UK), November 2025.
- “Automated algorithm configuration and applications”, presented at the Artificial Intelligence Research Group, University of York (UK), June 2023.
- “Theory-inspired parameter control benchmarks for dynamic algorithm configuration”, presented at the Workshop on Configuration and Selection of Algorithm (COSEAL), Germany, September 2022.
- “A constraint-based tool for generating benchmark instances”, presented at the 21st Workshop on Constraint Modelling and Reformulation, Israel, July 2022.
- “AutoIG: an automated instance generation system”, presented at CODES (Combinatorial Optimisation and Decision Support group) at KU Leuven (Belgium), at Laboratoire d’Informatique de Paris 6 (LIP6), Sorbonne University (France), and at the Nature Inspired Intelligent Systems group at Edinburgh Napier University (UK), May & June 2022.

Participation in invitation-based academic events:

- Dagstuhl Seminar on “Large Language Models for Evolutionary Computation”, Schloss Dagstuhl, Germany, May 2026.
- Dagstuhl Seminar on “Synergizing Theory and Practice of Automated Algorithm Design for Optimization”, Schloss Dagstuhl, Germany, August 2023.
- The Lorentz Center workshop on “Benchmarked: Optimisation Meets Machine Learning”, Leiden, Netherlands, May 2022.
- The Lorentz Center workshop on “Benchmarked: Optimisation Meets Machine Learning” (virtual), May 2021.